Potre Dirampatan-Diampuan

Dr. Potre Dirampatan-Diampuan is a Maranao educator, peacebuilder, interfaith leader, and halal industry advocate from Mindanao, Philippines.

For decades, she's been one of the more consistent and multifaceted bridge-builders in the country, working at the intersections of Islamic scholarship, educational reform, interfaith cooperation, and economic empowerment.

Whether she's pushing for stronger halal certification systems, convening religious dialogue across faiths, or writing about moral governance in the Bangsamoro, her work keeps returning to the same conviction: that sustainable peace starts with dignity, integrity, and genuine inclusion.

As CEO of the Alliance for Halal Integrity in the Philippines Inc. (AHIP), a former Global Council Trustee of the United Religions Initiative (URI), and co-author of pioneering scholarship on faith-based governance in the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao (BARMM), Dr. Potre stands as a quietly formidable figure in one of the Philippines' most complex and historically underserved regions.

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Background

Dr. Potre was born and raised in Marawi City and the broader Lanao area of Mindanao.

Her Maranao heritage isn't just cultural background; it's the foundation for everything she does.

The Maranao people's long history of struggle for Muslim autonomy in the Philippines, the weight of decades of conflict in Lanao, and the devastating 2017 Marawi siege have all made her advocacy deeply personal rather than purely academic.

After the siege, she was among the Maranao voices who spoke publicly about what displaced families most needed: not just infrastructure, but the right to rebuild their lives and their dignity on their own terms.

That grounded, community-first perspective runs through all of her work.

Education

Dr. Potre's academic path reflects both a strong local commitment and genuine international exposure.

She earned her Doctor of Philosophy in Educational Management from Mindanao State University (MSU) in Marawi City, where she also completed her Master of Arts in School Administration.

She holds a second master's degree in Cultural Anthropology from the University of the Philippines, which sharpened her analytical lens on identity, community, and social change.

In 2005, she was selected as a British Council Fellow at the University of Durham in the United Kingdom, an experience that significantly broadened her international perspective on peacebuilding, dialogue, and interfaith engagement.

These credentials aren't kept on a shelf. They've directly shaped her work training teachers, advising on Muslim education policy, and consulting for local government in Marawi and beyond.

Career

Education and Peacebuilding in the Classroom

Dr. Potre has long viewed education as a frontline tool for peace, not just a vehicle for academic achievement.

She's trained teachers to incorporate conflict-sensitive and peacebuilding approaches into everyday instruction, consulted on Muslim education initiatives for the Department of Education, and advised local government units in Marawi on education-related governance.

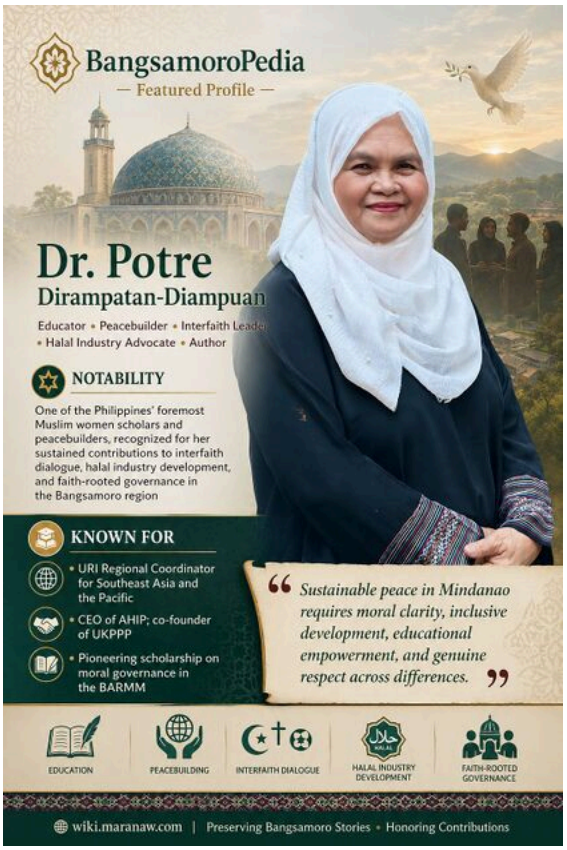
For her, schools aren't just places to teach subjects; they're spaces where young people either absorb prejudice or learn to dismantle it, and she's worked steadily to tip that balance toward the latter.

Interfaith Leadership and URI

Dr. Potre's profile in interfaith circles rose considerably when the United Religions Initiative (URI), one of the world's largest grassroots interfaith organizations, appointed her as Regional Coordinator for Southeast Asia and the Pacific around 2012.

She later served as Senior Interfaith Advisor for the Philippines and as a Global Council Trustee for the region from 2018 to 2022.

Dr. Potre Dirampatan-Diampuan



Origin
Marawi City, Lanao del Sur, Philippines
Ethnicity
Maranao
Religion
Islam
Education
Ph.D. Educational Management, Mindanao State University; M.A. School Administration, MSU; M.A. Cultural Anthropology, University of the Philippines; British Council Fellow, University of Durham, UK (2005)
Occupation
Educator, Peacebuilder, Interfaith Leader, Halal Industry Advocate, Author
Affiliations
United Religions Initiative (URI); Alliance for Halal Integrity in the Philippines Inc. (AHIP); National Commission on Muslim Filipinos

Through URI, she's consistently championed religious cooperation not as polite coexistence, but as active, practical collaboration on shared challenges like peace, community development, and reducing religious violence.

You'd find her at forums on Catholic social teaching like Laudato Si', in discussions on post-Marawi rehabilitation, and in quiet but persistent advocacy against Islamophobia in the Philippines and beyond.

(NCMF, consultant); UK-Philippines Partners for Peace (UKPPP, co-founder)
Notable Work
"Principles and Practice of Moral Governance in the Bangsamoro" (2021), in *Development for Peace*, co-authored with Dr. Nassef Manabilang Adiong
Notability
One of the Philippines' foremost Muslim women scholars and peacebuilders, recognized for her sustained contributions to interfaith dialogue, halal industry development, and faith-rooted governance in the Bangsamoro region
Known For
URI Regional Coordinator for Southeast Asia and the Pacific; CEO of AHIP; co-founder of UKPPP; pioneering scholarship on moral governance in the BARMM
Pull Quote
"Sustainable peace in Mindanao requires moral clarity, inclusive development, educational empowerment, and genuine respect across differences."

UK-Philippines Partners for Peace and NCMF

Dr. Potre co-founded the United Kingdom-Philippines Partners for Peace (UKPPP) alongside other Mindanao scholars, with backing from the British Council.

The initiative was designed to bring Mindanao-based expertise and perspectives into formal peace-support structures, connecting local knowledge with international networks and resources.

On the government side, she has consulted for the National Commission on Muslim Filipinos (NCMF) on peace programs and on efforts related to preventing and countering violent extremism (PCVE) in Muslim communities.

Halal Industry Advocacy and AHIP

In the economic dimension of her work, Dr. Potre serves as CEO of the Alliance for Halal Integrity in the Philippines Inc. (AHIP).

She's a consistent advocate for stronger halal standards, certification systems, regulatory frameworks, and consumer education in the Philippines.

Her argument is straightforward: halal integrity means accountability at every stage, from raw materials through production to the end consumer, and getting that right is both a matter of faith and a significant economic opportunity for Muslim-majority regions.

She engages government bodies like the Department of Trade and Industry, speaks at industry events, and keeps the conversation anchored in the real communities that stand to benefit.

For Dr. Potre, economic empowerment isn't separate from peacebuilding; it's one of its essential pillars.

Scholarly Contributions

In 2021, Dr. Potre co-authored the chapter "Principles and Practice of Moral Governance in the Bangsamoro" with Dr. Nassef Manabilang Adiong, published in the book *Development for Peace*.

The piece explores how the BARMM can move beyond conventional "good governance" frameworks toward a model of moral governance rooted in Islamic values, specifically principles like Faith, Freedom, Moral Authority, Common Good, and Social Ethics.

Importantly, the work doesn't advocate for exclusion; it argues for a faith-informed governance framework that remains genuinely inclusive of Christians, Indigenous Peoples, and all communities in the region.

The chapter directly engages with BARMM's real, present-day challenges: the corruption legacies carried over from the old ARMM era, the urgent need for merit-based appointments, and the kind of accountable leadership that actually serves the common good rather than entrenched interests.

The work has been cited in discussions by the Bangsamoro Parliament's research services and in international analyses of the Philippine peace process.

Legacy

Dr. Potre Dirampatan-Diampuan's career is a study in persistence and range.

She moves comfortably between university halls, diplomatic forums, government offices, halal trade conferences, and community gatherings, and she brings something real and substantive to each.

Her approach is characteristically Maranao and Muslim in the best sense: deeply rooted in faith and culture, pragmatic about governance and development, and stubbornly committed to dialogue even when progress is slow.

In a region where peace often feels like an unfinished project with no clear end date, she represents the kind of daily, multifaceted engagement that keeps the work moving forward.

She continues to consult, write, speak, and lead AHIP, always returning to the core conviction she's held throughout her career: that the Bangsamoro deserves moral clarity, economic opportunity, educational empowerment, and a peace built on genuine respect for every person in the region.

Recognition

- British Council Fellow, University of Durham, United Kingdom (2005)
- Regional Coordinator for Southeast Asia and the Pacific, United Religions Initiative (URI) (c. 2012)
- Senior Interfaith Advisor for the Philippines, United Religions Initiative
- Global Council Trustee for Southeast Asia and the Pacific, URI (2018–2022)
- Co-founder, United Kingdom-Philippines Partners for Peace (UKPPP)

Selected Works

- Dirampatan-Diampuan, P., and Adiong, N.M. (2021). "Principles and Practice of Moral Governance in the Bangsamoro." In *Development for Peace*. [Publisher details to be confirmed with source.]

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